

Now LTE in US navy
US navy fleet is planning to have a ship based LTE for closed quarter communication



Now Siri in your car
Nuance Communication has introduced a new Siri like platform called Dragon Drive designed specially for the connected car

NVIDIA GeForce GTX 670

Solid performance. Good value

The GeForce GTX 670 is the second card to be based on the fabled Kepler GK104 GPU and it's the perfect wingman for its flagship single core, the GTX 680. In fact the two cards are very similar. The GeForce GTX 670 ships with 1344 shader units (or CUDA Cores as NVIDIA like to call them) and seven SMX units as opposed to eight SMX units and 1536 CUDA Cores on the GTX 680. The memory subsystem of the GeForce GTX 670 is identical to the GTX 680, consisting of four 64-bit memory controllers (256-bit) with 2GB of GDDR5 memory. The similarity extends further to

the ROPs - both have 32 and the memory clock is the same too.

With 3D Mark 11 under the performance and extreme settings, the GTX 670 Physics scores were strangely enough



slightly better than the GTX 680. Perhaps the card managed to take some load off the CPU allowing it to throttle more, we're not sure. Other than that the scores were as expected - it beat the

HD 7970 in over half the tests. For the *Lost Planet 2* benchmark the 670 returned 105.3 FPS (at 720P med settings) while the GTX 680 got 108.9, so not much difference there.

The GTX 670 is a very capable card and it is almost astonishing to see it outperform the GTX 680 in a few tests. Giving equal weightage to each test, overall the GTX 670 gives roughly 95 percent of the performance of the GTX 680. The average GTX 670 is about ₹3,000 cheaper than the GTX 680. So you're getting 95 percent performance for 90 percent of the price. A decent value proposition.

Siddharth Parwatay

Specifications

Base Clock: 915MHz; **CUDA Cores:** 1344; **Memory Clock:** 6008MHz; **Video Memory:** 2 GB GDDR5; **Memory Bus Width:** 256-bit

Contact

NVIDIA
Email: pawasthi@nvidia.com
Website: www.nvidia.co.in
Phone: 22 6724 4800
Price: ₹ 29,000

8.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance 8.0
Build Quality 7.5
Value for Money 8.0

Specifications

Chipset: Intel Z77; **Expansion slots:** 3x PCIe x16, 1x PCI x1; **USB Ports:** 4x USB2.0, 2x USB 3.0; **Display Ports:** 1x HDMI, 1x DVI, 1xD-Sub, 1x DisplayPort; **SATA Ports:** 2x SATA 2, 3x SATA 3

Contact

GIGABYTE Technology India Pvt. Ltd.
E-mail: anilkumarr@gigabyte.in
Website: www.gigabyte.in
Price: ₹11,700

7.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance 7.0
Build Quality 7.5
Value for Money 7.5

Gigabyte Z77 G1 Sniper M3

Finally an mATX board from Gigabyte

Gigabyte has come out with a micro ATX form factor board from its gaming G1 series of boards, thereby providing some competition to the ASUS Maximus Gene series of boards. Out of the box, the G1 Sniper M3 looks very similar to its ATX cousins sans the bullet-magazine PCH heatsinks. The green and black aesthetics are maintained though. Two-way GPU setup is quite easy. Board layout is quite good but it only sports one 4-pin power connector, which may be limiting to an extent while over-



clocking. It sports a Creative CA0132 audio controller. There are only 4 SATA ports, with one extra port pointing upwards. For an enthusiast level board, it lacks dedicated power/reset and CMOS clear buttons as well as a POST error code read out. This is a huge letdown.

We tested the board using an Intel Core i7-3770K and Kingston 8GB DDR3 RAM on

Windows 7 64-bit OS. It gave scores which were within the margin of error of the other boards that we tested. The UEFI 3D BIOS is present on the Sniper M3 as well. Overclocking via the BIOS is quite easy from the MIT menu. We overclocked the Intel Core i7-3770K to 4.3 GHz on air thereby helping us to take the Cinebench R11.5 score from 6.12 to 7.28.

At an MRP of ₹11,700, it makes for an interesting board for those looking at an Ivy Bridge based gaming rig setup. The 4-pin power connector may not be ideal for extreme overclocking.

Nimish Sawant